MEMO

To: PPS Board of Education

From: Dr. Renard Adams, Chief Accountability and Equity Officer
William Fernandez, Director of Racial Equity and Social Justice

Date: June 20, 2026

Subject: RESJ Racial Equity and Social Justice Support Services Report

Background Information

This memo provides an update to the Board of Education and Superintendent Armstrong on the Racial Equity and Social Justice (RESJ) Support Services RFP partnerships for the 2025–26 school year.

2025–26 Community Partner Scope of Work

The process for tracking goals and activities was revised to create a more equitable and consistent approach aligned with District expectations. Community partners established goals connected to the District's Continuous Improvement Plan and Board goals in four priority areas: attendance, literacy, mathematics, and 9th-grade success.

Partners' strategies have been written as theories of action and aligned with the Ideal Student Experience to demonstrate measurable impact and illustrate how their work supports these priority areas. RESJ continues to review data from the PPS dashboard to assess partner performance and student outcomes in attendance, academic achievement, discipline, and graduation rates for high school students.

Data Observations

We are pleased to report that the majority of community partners demonstrated improvements in student attendance and on-track-to-graduation indicators.

There was, however, a noticeable increase in discipline incidents due to the addition of several categories that had not been tracked during the previous four years. These included Minor Defiance, Minor Disruptive Conduct, Minor Failure to Attend Class, Minor Insubordination/Defiance/Disobedience, Minor Not Following Directions, Minor Personal Electronic Device Violations, Minor Play Fighting, and Talking Too Loudly.

The inclusion of these categories significantly contributed to the overall increase in discipline incidents reported this year. The inclusion of these categories significantly contributed to the overall increase in discipline incidents reported this year. In response to this trend, the RESJ team will partner with Conduct and Discipline staff this summer to further examine this data, identify patterns that may be emerging across schools, and disaggregate incidents by race and other focal student groups. Using the District's Equity Lens, the teams will explore potential root causes, assess whether any disparities

exist, and determine what interventions, supports, or community partner strategies may be appropriate to address identified needs and promote equitable outcomes for students.

Looking Ahead

For the 2026–27 school year, RESJ staff collaborated with community partners to develop standardized pre- and post-program surveys to gather feedback from students and families regarding their experiences and the impact of partner programming. The survey data will provide valuable insights into participant engagement, sense of belonging, and overall program effectiveness. Findings from these surveys will be included in the Board memo presented in June 2027 to complement existing attendance, achievement, discipline, and graduation data.

Beginning on page 3, you will find detailed information about each organization, including the organization name, program description, RESJ strategy(ies) being implemented, schools served, and a link to the community partner performance review prepared by RESJ staff.

Community partners will also be submitting an end-of-year narrative to provide additional context and highlight outcomes; however, those reports are not due until June 19, 2026.

RESJ Partnership Programs

Proposer	Program Description, Summary & Strategy	Schools Served	Links to documents
African Youth and Community Organization (AYCO)	AYCO's UPLIFT program bridges the gap between students, parents, and schools to offer culturally-specific wrap-around support and mentoring to successfully navigate the educational system. The program is called UPLIFT because of the robust student support system that uplifts youth with programming reflective of our East African values and perspectives. Youth come to believe their cultural, religious, racial, and ethnic identity are an asset in a world of ableism, anti-Blackness, Islamophobia, and xenophobia. **Strategy 2: Warp-Around Services for Student Success** AYCO offers culturally-specific wrap-around support and mentoring to successfully navigate the educational system. Engage youth in value-rich activities with positive role models to help them stay on track not only academically, but also in the rest of their lives.	Ida B Wells, Franklin, McDaniel, Roosevelt, Jackson, Harrison Park,Woodmere, Lane, Markham, Rosa Parks, Roseway Heights.	Performance Review
Black Excellence (BE) Group	BE Group is a culturally relevant organization that is dedicated to serving historically underserved black students within Portland Public School. **Strategy 5**: **Positive Cultural Identity Development and Advocacy** BE Group program provides 25 weeks of black affinity small groups through a structured 5 module curriculum that intentionally pours into the students in a weekly small group play-based format that takes the students through our BE affirmational truths that they Belong, are Valued, Loved, Able, and Excellent.	Markham, Bridlemile, Rosa Parks, Dr. Martin Luther King Jr., Jackson, West Sylvan, Odyssey	Performance Review
Black Parent Initiative (BPI)	BPI's mission has been to educate and mobilize the parents and caregivers of African, African American and African American Multi-cultural children to ensure they achieve success. The impact of systemic racism on the Black/African American community includes extreme disparities in health, education, housing, employment, and more. Forced Displacement, structural violence and exclusion from economic opportunities for advancement have left many Black/African American families in Oregon in a position where they are unable to support the health and well-being of their children. BPI believes that children and families they serve are inherently capable, brilliant and beautiful though social service systems have historically neglected to center on their strengths, wisdom, promise and expertise. **Strategy 1: Culturally Specific Family Engagement** The Black Parent Initiative (BPI) proposes to provide Culturally Specific Family Engagement	**Strategy 1** Sabin, Boise-Eliot **Strategy 2:** Grant	Performance Review

	for several Portland Public Schools sites through our Sawubona School-Based Learning Communities. Aligning with the Racial Equity Student Support Services Strategy to create a welcoming and respectful environment for family and community engagement for Pre-K-5, BPI's Sawubona School-Based learning program will bring students, families, early learning providers, and school staff together to improve school readiness and success among African American, African, Black, and Multi-Ethnic students. **Strategy 2: Wrap-Around Services for Student Success** The Black Parent Initiative (BPI) proposes to expand our Sawubona wrap-around services to Grant High School, in collaboration with the Black Student Union to provide academic tutoring, culturally-specific mentorship, guest speakers, college prep, and access to career fairs and employment opportunities.		
Boys and Girls Club	Boys & Girls Club provides safe, positive places for kids to enjoy fun and engaging programs. Clubs provide enrichment programs to youth while empowering them with a sense of belonging and security, and surround members with caring, trained staff that engage them in nationally proven evidence-based youth development programs. This grant supports out-of-school time extended learning and enrichment programming (after school and summer). **Strategy 4**: **Enrichment, Extended Day** Programming model revolves around a full-age continuum of essential skills building, which means, intentionally creating an environment for youth and teens to develop essential skills from ages 6-18 for success in school, life and career through project-based, experiential learning, exploration, exposure, and application/practice.	Blazers Club (NE Portland) Wattles/Clegg Club (SE Portland)	Performance Review
Chess for Success	Through chess, all students in CFS after-school programs are introduced to concepts including: mindfulness, distress tolerance, emotional regulation, and interpersonal skills **Strategy 4: Enrichment, Extended Day** Chess for Success provides safe, inclusive, structured, fun and engaging activities that enhance and expand the learning of students outside of school hours.	Arleta, Bridger, Chief Joseph, James John, Kelly, Kellogg, MLK, Marysville, Rigler, Roseway Heights, Sabin, Scott, Vernon, Woodlawn	Performance Review
Coalition of Black Men	The COBM's mentoring program assists young African-American males and other boys develop into educated, contributing members of our community. It is designed to mold youth into leaders through responsible personal conduct, educational achievement and cultural enrichment. This is done through group coaching and community activities. **Strategy 3: Mentoring and Leadership**	Astor, Faubion, Ockley Green, and George	Performance Review

	The program continues its work focusing on cultural identity, career exploration, self-efficacy, and leadership through its full school year vision board development journey. The program also includes a reading support feature, titled "Readers Become Leaders," led by a former high school teacher with extensive knowledge in special education.		
Girl Scouts	Forever friendship is a powerful thing. It's what gives Girl Scouts the confidence to be themselves, unapologetically. It's what makes them feel safe enough to try new things and cheer each other on in tough times. It's the support that can get them up on tough mornings, help them raise their hand in class, and even climb to the top of a mountain. **Strategy 4**: **Enrichment, Extended Day** Girl Scouts provides provide opportunities for students of color to access enriching after school programming, improve engagement in school, build and recognize a sense of achievement (self & others), grow interpersonal and inter-relational skills with peers and adult mentors, build a sense of belonging and safety through tools and practice with emotional resilience, mental wellness, and community familiarity.	Boise-Eliot, Peninsula	Performance Review
Immigrant and Refugee Community Organization (IRCO)	IRCO's mission is to welcome, serve, and empower refugees, immigrants, and people across cultures and generations to reach their full potential. We imagine a future where refugees and immigrants belong, our staff are nurtured, and all communities thrive. Founded by refugees for refugees, IRCO has been serving Oregon's immigrant and refugee communities for nearly 50 years. IRCO supports K-12 students with holistic, wraparound services that promote academic success through afterschool groups, mentoring, tutoring, academic advocacy, family engagement, and community celebrations. **Strategy 1: Culturally Specific Family Engagement** Supporting academic, social, and emotional learning and positive cultural identities is integral to IRCO's programming by providing individualized support, in home learning, family group activities and outreach engagement **Strategy 2: Wrap-Around Services for Student Success** Bilingual/Bicultural Advocates provide individualized support to a caseload of students to support with grades, attendance, sense of belonging at school, academic skill building, by providing case management, student group activities, and summer programming. **Strategy 3: Mentoring and Leadership** Bilingual/Bicultural mentors will provide relationship-based mentorship to a caseload of students to support with grades, attendance, academic skill building, linkages to other services and programs (e.g., SUN community schools), support with communication with teachers about progress and challenges, support with disciplinary incidents, and preparation for high school success. **Strategy 5: Positive Cultural Identity Development and Advocacy**	**Strategy 1** Sitton, Jason Lee, Clark (HP), Kelly **Strategy 2** Roosevelt HS, McDaniel HS, Franklin HS **Strategy 3 & 5** Roseway Heights, Harrison Park, Lane George, Roseway, Harrison Park	Performance Review

	Programming will provide youth with exposure and opportunities to engage in activities that empower them to embrace a confident and positive cultural identity while preserving and sharing cultural heritages and traditions amongst their peers. Activities provide opportunities for students to learn and practice new methods of self-expression in a safe and culturally affirming environment.		
iUrban Teen	iUrban delivers an after-school program titled iMentor to help address unfinished learning grounded in equity that accelerates learning by building on strengths and addressing needs of students and their communities. The program will center on high quality, culturally affirming instruction, leadership, and programming. Mentoring programs are vital tools in supporting the success of students of color. **Strategy 3**: **Mentoring and Leadership** iMentor addresses unfinished learning grounded in equity that accelerates learning by building on strengths and addressing needs of students and their communities. The program will center on high quality, Culturally Affirming instruction, leadership, and programming. Mentoring programs are vital tools in supporting the success of students of color.	McDaniel, Jefferson	Performance Review
Latino Network	Latino Network is a Latine-led education organization, grounded in culturally-specific practices and services, that lifts up youth and families to reach their full potential. The work springs from the core belief in Latino community self-determination—that is, the ability of community members to participate meaningfully in the decisions that affect their lives and the lives of their families. **Strategy 1**: **Culturally Specific Family Engagement** Juntos Aprendemos program brings Latino children and their parents or caregivers to their neighborhood school for 30 weekly, 2 hour-long classes. In Juntos, children become confident participants in our weekly reading circle; they engage in age-appropriate activities for learning letters, numbers, and colors; they enhance their ability to use language and to socialize positively with peers and teachers; and they experience themselves as successful in the school environment. **Strategy 2: Wrap-Around Services for Student Success** Our program aims to foster better academic outcomes and advocate for a fairer educational experience by focusing on mentoring, leadership, and support for both students and parents. This includes group sessions focused on academic support, tutoring, social-emotional skill development, healthy relationship building, and engaging enrichment opportunities promoting positive cultural identity and college and career readiness. **Strategy 5: Positive Cultural Identity Development and Advocacy**	**Strategy 1** Cesar Chavez, Lent **Strategy 2** Roosevelt, McDaniel, Franklin, Benson, Alliance **Strategy 3** Kellogg, Lane, **Strategy 5** Roseway Heights, Harrison Park, Beaumont, Hosford, Robert Gray, Faubion, George, Tubman, Vernon, daVinci, Jackson, Astor	Performance Review

	Students Organizing for Leadership (SOL) is an 8-month culturally specific youth leadership program that empowers students to engage in civic activities grounded in social justice, community empowerment and the promotion of their wellbeing. SOL invites Latinx middle school students from across Multnomah County to explore leadership, issue-based advocacy, higher education, and professional development.		
Maurice Lucas Foundation	The Maurice Lucas Foundation is carrying on Maurice's work by creating transformational opportunities for middle school, high school and post-high school students by providing a combination of school programs, experiences, and sport. Through positive interactions with program coaches, team members, and community role models, we help youth develop their cognitive, emotional, intellectual and social skills in a fun environment. **Strategy 4: Enrichment, Extended Day** The program of services MLF is proposing is based on our established Academy Program, which forms the core of our mission of Teaching Life Lessons Through Education and Sport – with after school services including character development exercises, culturally responsive curricula, physical activities, academic supports, guest speakers, college tours, family engagement events and educational field trips. The program will also be enhanced and strengthened by the addition of social emotional learning, career awareness opportunities and high dosage tutoring in smaller group settings.	Harriet Tubman Jefferson, Benson, Grant, Cleveland, McDaniel, Roosevelt, Franklin	Performance Review
Native American Youth and Family Center (NAYA)	NAYA offers a wide array of comprehensive services and community-based solutions, including lifelong educational opportunities, cultural identity, leadership development, Elder support, homes for families, early childhood programs, and paths to financial security based on traditional tribal values. We are committed to eliminating poverty, hunger, family violence, and homelessness. **Strategy 1: Culturally Specific Family Engagement** NAYA Youth Advocates work to support families accessing school and school staff and to assist with building positive relationships throughout the education process. These positive relationships encourage meaningful connection to the educational experience by lending a hand with tutoring, parent teacher meetings, IEP and 504 meetings, and if needed, disciplinary meetings. **Strategy 2: Wrap-Around Services for Student Success** NAYA Family Center has provided after school tutoring and educational advocacy, working one-on one with the students, for over seventeen years to help youth understand their academic strengths and to address challenge areas. Advocates meet with students at NAYA and in their schools and homes so that relationships can be built with educators and family members. **Strategy 3: Mentoring/Leadership Strategy**	**Strategy 1** NAYA, schools that are fed by youth in the Cully neighborhood, and throughout PPS. **Strategy 2** NAYA, schools that are fed by youth in the Cully neighborhood, and throughout PPS. **Strategy 3** NAYA, schools that are fed by youth in the Cully	Performance Review

	These positive relationships encourage meaningful connection to the educational experience by lending a hand with tutoring, parent teacher meetings, IEP and 504 meetings, and if needed, disciplinary meetings. When needed, NAVA provides or refers to its own wrap around support to meet the critical needs of the community and provide stability. **Strategy 5**: **Positive Cultural Identity Development and Advocacy** Our programming includes a diverse array of enrichment activities with a strong emphasis on Culture, Education and Wellness through a decolonized lens. For this grant, we are seeking to fund Culture, Education, and Wellness activities within our out-of-school programs including Learning Center, Culture Night, Two Spirit Safe Space Alliance, Recreation and Wellness, and Seasonal Camps. The Two Spirit Safe Space Alliance (TSSSA) meets for two hours bi-monthly for 2 hours on site at NAYA throughout the school year, with additional field trips and participation in events such as the Oregon Queer Youth Summit and Portland Pride.	neighborhood, and throughout PPS. **Strategy 5** NAYA, schools that are fed by youth in the Cully neighborhood, and throughout PPS.	
Open School	At Step Up, we believe every child deserves to learn and grow in an environment that meets them where they are. In response to systemic inequities and the limitations of one-size-fits-all education, we're on a mission to create a more equitable future where underestimated and underserved youth feel seen, supported, and empowered at every stage of their academic journey. We commit ourselves personally and professionally by working to keep dominant culture from being the basis of how we relate to one another, operate as an organization, and educate and engage the students, families, and communities we are charged to serve. **Strategy 2**: **Wrap-Around Services for Student Success** Step Up will deliver daily, culturally specific services to promote academic, emotional, and social success for BIPOC, ELL, and other priority students. Services will encompass individual case management, one-on-one and small-group academic tutoring, extensive external service referrals, therapeutic counseling, facilitated student affinity groups, and rigorous progress monitoring. SU's program goals are aligned with district priorities and Smart Goals, ensuring relevance and effectiveness.	Franklin, Roosevelt, and McDaniel High Schools	Performance Review
POIC	POIC+RAHS provides culturally specific and culturally responsive wraparound services to students who have transitioned from a Portland Public Schools (PPS) location to one of PPS' alternative school partners. POIC+RAHS would offer students a variety of supports to promote student academic, emotional, and social success.POIC+RAHS has become the subject matter expert on engaging, serving, and connecting local marginalized and disconnected young adults with programs and services to build resilience and self-reliance **Strategy 3: Mentoring and Leadership**	Clark, Vernon, Rosemary Anderson, Bridger, Marysville	Performance Review

	POIC+RAHS will deliver a Peer Mentoring Program through which POIC+RAHS students provide group mentoring support for elementary and middle school students enrolled at Portland Public Schools. Students will discuss bullying and prevention; mental health awareness and support for peers; goal setting; self-care; volunteerism; race relations and police interactions; and violence prevention and personal safety.		
REAP	REAP is on a mission to proactively ignite, elevate, and engage the next wave of leaders for the future now. With two decades of providing social services and engaging communities with an emphasis on addressing gaps for culturally diverse students and families. REAP programs offer customized skill-building for students using restorative justice and trauma-informed practices to maximize their potential. REAP also provides professional development opportunities for students, fostering overall school site growth. **Strategy 2: Wrap-Around Services for Student Success** REAP will provide activities and services to increase family engagement in order to reduce or eliminate institutional barriers for families of color to advocate for the needs of their students. Students learn and demonstrate school/community leadership skills; develop and strengthen academic skills needed for school success, college readiness, and future careers; bolster positive behavior, relational communication, and problem-solving skills; and learn the value of serving and collaborating within their community.	Franklin, Kellogg, Lane, and Mt Tabor	Performance Review
Sankofa Counseling	Sankofa Counseling offers an opportunity for families to connect with BIPOC mental health professionals in a supportive setting. By having therapists available to answer questions and provide information about mental health services and supports, Sankofa Counseling facilitates access to culturally specific resources and support networks for families. **Strategy 1: Culturally Specific Family Engagement** Family engagement nights: Sankofa Counseling will host quarterly family nights for Black/African American families to gather, connect in affirming community, engage culturally specific practices and learn about community resources. Family nights will include a shared meal and a 10 minute keynote highlighting an aspect of health and wellness. Families will participate in a communal activity, such as AfroFusion yoga, creating a family art project, community team building, etc. We will have a team of therapists available for answering questions and connecting to local mental health services & supports. Quarterly Family Engagement Nights provide a platform for Black/African American families to come together in a culturally affirming environment. By hosting these nights, PPS demonstrates a commitment to partnering with the community and delivering services that center cultural practices. The communal activities, such as AfroFusion yoga and family art projects, are designed to create opportunities for family bonding and deepening connection with community.	Kellogg, Benson/Jefferson, Franklin, McDaniel	Performance Review

	Strategy 5: Positive Cultural Identity Development and Advocacy Engaging families in activities that promote cultural connection and community building contributes to the positive cultural identity development of students. By fostering strong connections between families and schools, these events support student advocacy and enhance the overall well-being of students and their families.		
Self Enhancement Inc. (SEI)	SEI is a comprehensive, one-stop resource for youth and families, primarily serving African Americans and others living in poverty or seeking culturally responsive services. It is also one of the city's leading multi-service organizations, providing thousands of youth, families, and adults with a wide array of education and social services on an annual basis. SEI's strength lies in its ability to meet the complex needs of its children and families, including helping people overcome cultural, educational, and economic barriers.Working with schools, families, and partner community organizations, SEI provides support, guidance, and opportunities to achieve personal and academic success. SEI brings hope to individual young people and enhances the quality of community life. **Strategy 1: Culturally Specific Family Engagement** SEI's culturally specific Parent Involvement Program activities and resources, organized and delivered by coordinators assigned to the identified PPS priority schools, build bridges connecting the school, family, community, and child, toward shared goals and outcomes for equity and inclusion; academic achievement; and healthy social-emotional and physical development. **Strategy 2**: **Wrap-Around Services for Student Success** SEI In-School Service Coordinators housed on-site address/eliminate barriers to school success and improve assets among participating students, consistent with school and district goals; e.g., improved academic achievement, on-time promotion to the next grade level, and on-time high school graduation. SEI also provides family outreach, engagement, education, and other support and resources designed to help parents/caregivers be effective partners in their children's learning, at home and at school. **Strategy 4: Enrichment and Extended Day** SEI's After-School Program (ASP) proposes to expand culturally specific academic support and enrichment classes for African American middle and high school students from the targeted PPS priority schools. ASP is offered at the Center for Self Enhancement in three-hour blocks on Mondays-Thursdays for 27 weeks (including SEI Enhancement Days over breaks) during the regular school year, starting in October. Middle and high school students each spend two days at the Center (and take part in regular shared cross-grade events), and ASP is coordinated with SUN Community School activities at their buildings on other days.	**Strategy 1 & 4** Boise-Eliot **Strategy 1, 2 & 4** Jefferson **Strategy 4** Tubman	Performance Review

Samoan Pacific Development Corporation (SPDC)	Samoa Pacific Development Corporation or "SPDC" serves the Samoan community in Oregon through educational and economic resources and cultural empowerment. SPDC's main focus is addressing low graduation and attendance by increasing parent and family engagement through culturally specific programs. Our hope is that students will graduate from high school prepared with what's to come. **Strategy 2**: **Wrap-Around Services for Student Success** SPDC's experience piloting this program since 2022 has shown that culturally responsive mentoring, academic and career support, leadership development, cultural enrichment activities and financial assistance to families are effective in improving outcomes for PI youth.	Roosevelt High School	Performance Review
The I Am Academy (TIAA)	The I Am Academy provides young men and women with a life changing experience, which empowers, encourages, and enables them to develop needed social-emotional tools and academic confidence for success in school and beyond. The discussions and activities focus on deepening their understanding of self, cultural identity, academic strengths, and social and emotional competence. **Strategy 3: Mentoring and Leadership** I AM Academy believes the best self-defense against student discontent, disinterest, crime, and the allure of gang involvement, lies in guiding students to explore and cultivate their self-chosen, self-identified goals, and career aspirations, as a means of embracing self-accountability, as well as self-protection.	Roosevelt High School, Franklin High School	Performance Review